



AGENCY FOR HEALTHCARE RESEARCH AND QUALITY



MEPS-HC Health Insurance Data

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Questionnaire Sections That Collect Health Insurance Variables

- **Employment (EM)**
- **Health Insurance (HX)**
- **Health Insurance Detailed (HP)**
- **Time Period Covered (HQ)**
- **Review of Old Public Related Insurance (PR)**
- **Old Employment/Private Related Insurance (OE)**

Insurance Information Collected



- **Insurance Types**
 - ▶ Medicare
 - ▶ Medicaid/SCHIP
 - ▶ Other Public
 - ▶ Private Insurance
- **Coverage status as of interview date and each month**
- **Main focus is hospital/physician coverage**

Insurance Coverage Status Variables

- **Various insurance types available in MEPS**
 - ▶ Overview using monthly variables as an example (slides 5-7)
- **Coverage status captured at different time points and durations**
 - ▶ Overview using Medicaid/CHIP as an example (slides 8, 9)

Public Insurance Types

Using Monthly Indicators (as of Jan. 2024) as an example

- **MCRJA24X** Medicare
- **MCDJA24X** Medicaid/State Children's Health Insurance Program (SCHIP)
- **TRIJA24X** TRICARE/CHAMPVA
- **VAPJA24** Veteran's Administration (VA)
- **IHSJA24** Indian Health Service (IHS)
- **GVAJA24** Other public insurance
- **GVBJA24** Other public health maintenance organization (HMO)
- **GVCJA24** Other public, pay premium

Edited variables end in an X.

Private Insurance Types

Using Monthly Indicator (as of Jan. 2024) as an example

- **PEGJA24** Employer/union group insurance
- **PNGJA24** Non-group private insurance
- **PRXJA24** Coverage through Exchanges
- **POGJA24** Other group private insurance
- **PDKJA24** Unknown source of insurance
- **POEJA24** Policyholder is outside reporting unit (RU), employment-related
- **PNEJA24** Policyholder is outside RU, not related to employment

Summary Variables

Using Monthly Indicator (as of Jan. 2024) as an example

- **PUBJA24X**: Indicates public insurance in month
- **PRIJA24**: Indicates private insurance in month
- **INSJA24X**: Indicates any insurance in month

Timing and Duration of Coverage (1)

Using Medicaid/SCHIP as an example

- **MCDmm24X**
 - ▶ Covered in the month of *mm* (JA, . . . , DE) in 2024
- **MCAID24X**
 - ▶ Covered as of December 31, 2024
- **MCDEV24**
 - ▶ Covered at any time in 2024

Timing and Duration of Coverage (2)



Using Medicaid/SCHIP as an example

- **MCAID31X, MCAID42X, MCAID53X**
 - ▶ Covered as of Round 3/1*, 4/2, 5/3 interview date
- **MCDAT31X, MCDAT42X, MCDAT53X**
 - ▶ Covered any time in Round 3/1, 4/2, 5/3.
- **MCDAT24X**
 - ▶ Covered any time in Round 5 or 3 until December 31, 2024

* Round 3 for the second-year panel and Round 1 for the first-year panel. Round 4/2 and 5/3 are similarly defined.

Year-Level Insurance Summary Variables



- **UNINS24: Uninsured all of 2024**
- **INSCOV24: Health Insurance Coverage Indicator for 2024**
 - 1. Any private: Person had any private insurance coverage* at any time during 2024**
 - 2. Public only: Person had only public insurance coverage** during 2024**
 - 3. Uninsured: Person was uninsured during all of 2024**

***: including TRICARE/CHAMPVA; **: excluding TRICARE/CHAMPVA**

Year-Level Insurance Summary Variables (continued)



- **INSURC24: Similar to INSCOV24, but detailed categories for 65+**

Note: TRICARE/CHAMPVA is private in INSCOV24 and INSURC24, but public in all other summary variables.

Policyholder – Dependent Relationships

- Policyholder/dependent indicators for private coverage are available at the monthly level.

Using status as of January as an example

- HPEJA24 Employer/union group insurance
- HPNJA24 Non-group private insurance
- HPXJA24 Coverage through Exchanges
- HPOJA24 Other group private insurance
- HPDJA24 Unknown source of insurance
- HPRJA24 Any private insurance

Managed Care and Benefits

- **Medicare**
 - ▶ Medicare Advantage
 - ▶ Part D Prescription Drug Benefit
 - ▶ Medicare Advantage Dental Benefit
- **Medicaid/SCHIP**
 - ▶ HMOs
 - ▶ Gatekeeper Plans
- **Private Insurance**
 - ▶ HMOs
 - ▶ Dental Benefits

Flexible Spending Account (FSA), Round 1/3



- **FSAGT31: Indicator of whether any family member had a Flexible Spending Account (FSA)**
- **HASFSA31: Indicator of which family member held an FSA**
- **PFSAMT31: Total FSA contribution for each person with an FSA**

Duration of Uninsurance

- **Indicator of coverage status in the prior 2 years, conditional on no coverage reported as of Jan. 1 of the first year**
 - ▶ **PREVCOVR: Any health insurance coverage**
 - ▶ **MORECOVR: Hospital/physician coverage**

Medical Debt Variables (Round 4/2)

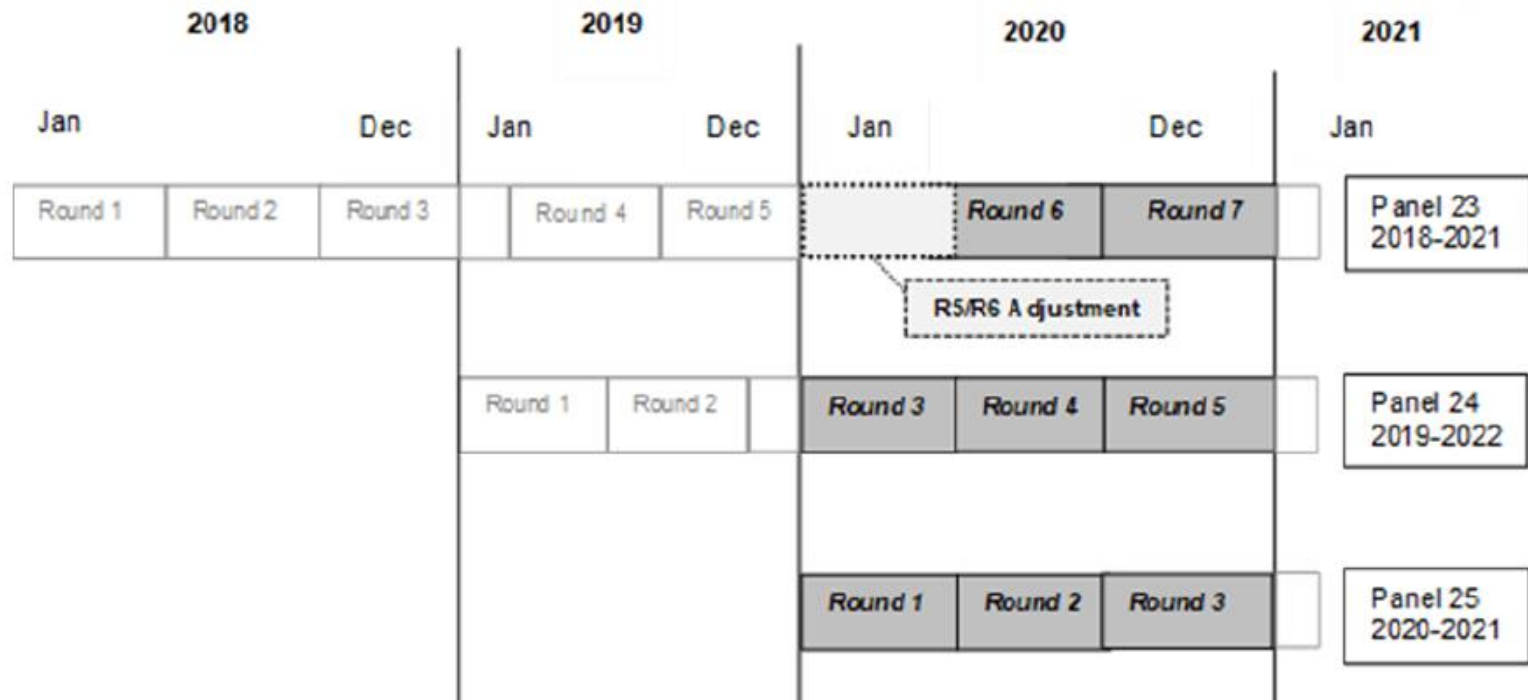
- **PROBPY42:** Indicator for problems paying medical bills in the family in the past 12 months.
- **CRFMPY42:** Indicator for someone in the family currently paying medical bills over time.
- **PYUNBL42:** Indicator for someone in the family currently having unpaid medical bills.

Major Changes Made in 2018



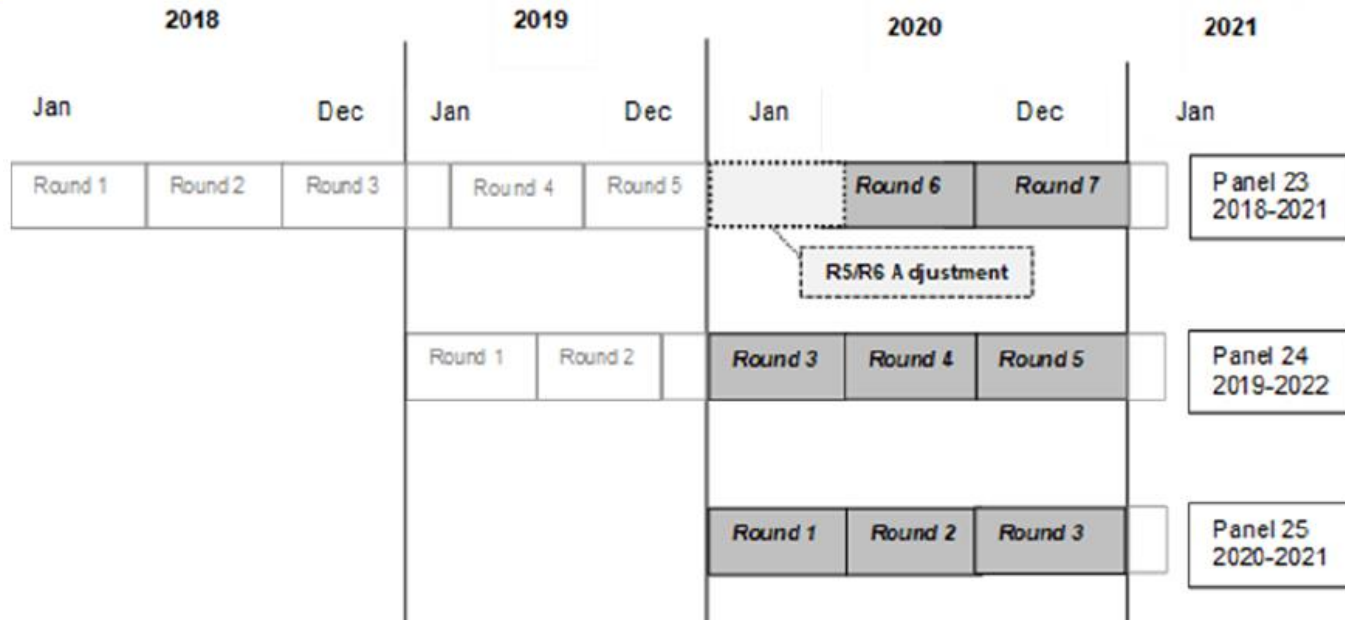
- **Design changes to increase coverage reporting may impact trend analyses.**
- **For example, a verification module was added.**
 - ▶ **Respondents not reporting hospital/physician coverage were asked to verify coverage status and type.**
 - ▶ **Indicator for hospital/physician coverage reported through the verification module included.**

Major Changes in 2020 due to COVID-19 Pandemic



- The decision to extend Panel 23 occurred after Panel 23 Round 5 was fielded.
- Therefore, Round 5 was fielded as a traditional terminal round where questions are asked as of 12/31/2019.

Major Changes in 2020 due to COVID-19 Pandemic



Adjustment made to R5 variables for Panel 23

- “At interview date” variables: created using the information obtained during R6 interview.
- FSA variables: collected in first round of the panel in each year, so the value is set to -1.

Thank You!



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